protecting a mint and the latter making a mint, and determined to protect these things at all cost, even in the face of our vulnerability and our chutzpah. They immediately brought a case against us in San Francisco, as a result of which the judge repealed our domain name, WikiLeaks.org, and demanded to know who had registered it and from what address. The company, Dinadot, immediately rolled over and closed the site. But we had set a trap for our opponents by registering in San Francisco, the cultural centre of gravity for the cypherpunks and the Californian instinct for non-conformity and free speech. They could have sued us in Switzerland or London, but by going through with San Francisco they immediately faced the wrath of the ACLU, the Committee of the Freedom of the Press and many other organisations. When we went back to court we had twenty-two organisations and a battalion of lawyers fighting for us, with favourable coverage in the *New York Times* and CBS giving out our domain number (since the name was banned) in order to reach us (‘Free speech has a number’). We had set up other ways of accessing our site, anyway, via secret links and mirror sites, which we knew would come in useful. You’ve got to remember, we established ourselves knowing we would, early and late, be dealing with the Chinese and their throwing-up of firewalls.

We won the case completely against Julius Baer and it was seen as being a crucial win, not only for us but for First Amendment campaigners all over the place. The bank were just about to launch themselves in America before the court case, and afterwards they held off. It was an important victory because it showed how WikiLeaks would stand up to just about anyone and not be immediately crushed by those who could pay for the kind of lawyers who facilitate such crushing. The sub-prime thing was riding high and the British mortgage lender Northern Rock had already gone under. It was looking like a bad time for a private bank to be suing the arse off a not-for-profit whistleblowing team.

The real tragedy of this incident was that it finally saw the end of Daniel Mathews’ involvement with WikiLeaks. Dan’s name was on quite a few bits of paperwork, and Julius Baer were looking for anybody and everybody they could prosecute. He was sitting in his office at Stanford one afternoon, marking his students’ homework, when some bloke walked in with a huge stack of paper and slapped it down on the desk. He told me afterwards that his first thought was that it was the biggest homework assignment he’d ever seen, but, no, it was a subpoena. Dan found this quite scary and afterwards